ABITUR ENGLISH · WRITING

analyse · examine

How to show how a text works – and why

WHAT DO “ANALYSE” AND “EXAMINE” MEAN?

“describe and explain in detail and give evidence from the text, relating the content to relevant aspects of language and form”

Both operators mean the same thing. *analyse* (British) and *analyze* (American) are both correct.

The key: point – evidence – effect

Every paragraph of your analysis follows these three steps.

POINT
What does the author do?
Her use of language underlines how serious the loss is.

EVIDENCE
Which device? Where?
The metaphor “tears another hole in the fabric of our towns” (l. 8) …

EFFECT
What does it achieve?
… presents the town as fragile and slowly destroyed.

Dos and don’ts

DO	DON’T
✓ device + evidence + **effect**	× list devices
✓ **every focus** after *Focus on …*	× skip a focus
✓ group by **aspects**	× go through the text line by line
✓ **short** quotations: “…” (l. 8)	× long quotations, „…“, *line 8*
✓ **simple present**, neutral	× retell the text, give your opinion
✓ *the narrator* in fiction	× *the author* for a first-person narrator

Step by step

Model task: **Analyse how the author conveys her concern about the decline of local bookshops. Focus on communicative strategies and use of language.**

STEP	WHAT TO DO	MODEL TASK (page 3)
① **Task**	Underline the **aspect** and **every focus**.	her concern · strategies + language
② **Collect**	Mark devices, note **line** and **effect**.	anecdote (ll. 1-4) → sympathy · metaphor (l. 8) → destruction
③ **Group**	Pick the best devices, group them **by focus**.	¶1 strategies · ¶2 language
④ **Write**	(Opening) · one **P – EV – EF** paragraph per group · short conclusion	see page 3
⑤ **Check**	Every device with evidence **and** effect? Every focus?	both foci · every quotation explained

Typical tasks in the Abitur 2026

- *Analyse the various reasons for the success of Silent Book Clubs. Focus on communicative strategies and use of language.*
- *Analyse how Lara perceives … Tom Lake and its surroundings. Focus on use of language.*
- *Analyse the interaction between Gabriel's parents and Beth … Focus on narrative situation as well as use of language.*

→ Every focus needs its own part of your answer.

Toolbox: terms

USE OF LANGUAGE

word choice · emotive language · metaphor · simile · repetition · enumeration · contrast · hyperbole

COMMUNICATIVE STRATEGIES

anecdote · facts and figures · rhetorical question · inclusive *we* · direct address · irony · call to action

NARRATIVE TECHNIQUES

first-/third-person narrator · point of view · characterisation · dialogue · setting · atmosphere · symbol

STRUCTURE AND VISUALS

headline · opening · line of argument · climax · ending · photo/cartoon and its function

Useful phrases

Opening (optional)	**Einleitung (optional)**
In the commentary "…", **the author conveys** … **mainly by** …	Im Kommentar „…" vermittelt die Autorin … vor allem durch …
Device and evidence	**Mittel und Beleg**
The author uses an anecdote / a metaphor …	Die Autorin verwendet eine Anekdote / eine Metapher …
The metaphor "…" (l. 8) …	Die Metapher „…" (Z. 8) …
Effect	**Wirkung**
This emphasises / highlights …	Das betont / hebt hervor …
This suggests that …	Das deutet darauf hin, dass …
This creates the impression that …	Das erweckt den Eindruck, dass …
The reader is encouraged to …	Der Leser wird dazu angeregt, …
Link to the task	**Bezug zur Aufgabe**
In this way, the author conveys …	Auf diese Weise vermittelt die Autorin …
Connecting and concluding	**Verbinden und abschließen**
To begin with … / **Moreover** … / **In addition** …	Zunächst … / Darüber hinaus … / Zudem …
All in all, …	Alles in allem …

AVOID

× *There is a metaphor in l. 8.*
✓ *The metaphor … suggests that …*

× *This shows … This shows …*
✓ *emphasises · suggests · evokes*

× *"another hole" (l. 8).* – alone
✓ *… as tearing "another hole" (l. 8), which …*

Model solution

MODEL TEXT (INVENTED FOR PRACTICE · LEVEL B2/C1)

Closing Time for the High Street Bookshop – commentary by Helen Ward, *The Ashbridge Courier*

When Ruth Carter opened her bookshop in Ashbridge in 1987, there were four others on the same street. Today, hers is the only one left – and next spring, it will close too. Ruth is not giving up because people have stopped reading. She is giving up because we have stopped walking through her door.

We all know the reasons. A paperback costs two pounds less online, and it arrives the next morning without our having to leave the sofa. Convenient? Certainly. But what are we really buying? Across the country, hundreds of independent bookshops have closed in recent years, and each closure tears another hole in the fabric of our towns.

A bookshop is not just a place where books are sold. It is a place where a stranger recommends a novel you would never have chosen, where children sit on the floor and read, where a lonely pensioner finds someone to talk to. An algorithm can tell you what "customers also bought". It cannot ask you how you are.

So the next time you are about to click "Buy now", ask yourself one question: what kind of high street do we want to leave to our children?

Analyse how the author conveys her concern about the decline of local bookshops. Focus on communicative strategies and use of language.

P point EV evidence EF effect · phrases from page 2 in **bold**

OPENING (optional)

In her commentary "Closing Time for the High Street Bookshop", Helen Ward **conveys** her concern about the decline of local bookshops **mainly by** appealing to the readers' emotions and making them feel partly responsible.

PARAGRAPH 1 (communicative strategies)

P **To begin with**, the author uses a personal story and inclusive language to involve the readers. EV She tells them that Ruth Carter's shop is "the only one left" (l. 2) and is about to close. EF This anecdote makes the problem concrete and turns an abstract trend into a personal fate, so the readers are more likely to sympathise with Ruth. EV She then explains that Ruth is giving up because "we have stopped walking through her door" (l. 4). EF By using the inclusive "we", the author makes the readers feel responsible without attacking them directly.

PARAGRAPH 2 (use of language)

P **Moreover**, her use of language underlines how serious the loss is. EV The metaphor that each closure "tears another hole in the fabric of our towns" (l. 8) EF presents the town as something fragile that is being destroyed piece by piece. EV **In addition**, the enumeration of "where" clauses (cf. ll. 9-11) EF **emphasises** what a bookshop offers beyond books and **evokes** a warm, human atmosphere. EV This warm picture contrasts sharply with the "algorithm" (l. 11), which "cannot ask you how you are" (l. 12). EF **In this way, the author conveys** her concern that online shopping cannot replace what a town loses with its bookshop.

CONCLUSION

All in all, the author conveys her concern through a personal story, inclusive language and emotive imagery, which makes the decline of bookshops appear both sad and something the readers themselves can change.

ALSO POSSIBLE – BUT YOU DON'T NEED EVERYTHING

- the rhetorical questions (ll. 6-7, 13-14) and the call to action at the end (cf. l. 13)
- the short question and answer "Convenient? Certainly." (l. 6)
- the structure: from one shop to the whole country to the reader's own decision

→ Two well-explained paragraphs are better than ten devices without effect.